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RISKDESK — Daily Intelligence

FRI 2026-07-31 • 08:45 CT • TODAY FIRST + LOOKBACK • 12-SOURCE ROSTER

EDITION 001

CFO BRIEF — THREE TAKEAWAYS, WRITTEN TO BE READ ALOUD

1. **Casualty severity:** a \$604M nuclear verdict hit C.H. Robinson this week; 2025 logged 149 such verdicts (\$25.1B). Worth re-testing our umbrella limits against that curve.
2. **Buyer's market:** commercial property rates fell 12% in Q2 (all lines –6%), and analysts doubt even a \$100B catastrophe would harden the market — a favorable renewal window.
3. **Cyber posture:** manufacturing was the most-attacked industry for a 5th straight year (27.7% of 2025 incidents) — the external case for our cyber tower.

STORIES

25

today first • kept-critical lookback

VERDICT WATCH

\$604M

C.H. Robinson, Dallas County

PROPERTY RATES, Q2

–12%

global index; all lines –6%

MFG SHARE OF CYBER

27.7%

most-attacked industry, 5th yr

H1 CAT LOSSES

\$112B

only \$44B insured

TOP STORIES 7

Global disaster losses dip below average as Venezuela quake and heatwaves signal rising risk

Risk & Insurance • Jul 31

H1 2026: ~\$112B economic losses, only \$44B insured. **Why it matters:** a significant protection gap heading into peak hurricane season.

Q2 Global Insurance Market Index: rates fall 6%, property drops 12%

Beinsure • Q2 index

Increased capital, cheaper reinsurance, and competition are favoring buyers. **Why it matters:** hard numbers behind the soft market — leverage for your renewal.

Super El Niño will redraw global catastrophe risk

Insurance Business America • Jul 31

Atlantic hurricane threat eases while Pacific, wildfire, and flood exposures climb. **Why it matters:** the cat-risk map your property program is priced on is moving.

Most commercial property accounts arrive with a valuation gap

Insurance Business America · Jul 31

Underinsured schedules risk coinsurance penalties at claim time. **Why it matters:** a quiet check worth running on plant and equipment values.

US Midwest severe storms, wind, hail & tornadoes may rank as a top-10 severe weather loss

Artemis / Aon · Jul 31

Aon says the event could rank among the costliest on record. **Why it matters:** direct watch item for Midwest plants and property programs.

P&C market enters correction phase with significant rate relief and emerging challenges

Risk & Insurance · 2026

General & product liability tentatively stabilizing in manufacturing segments. **Why it matters:** timing looks favorable to push on rate.

\$100bn event may not be enough to cause a hard market, say Berenberg analysts

Artemis · Jul 31

Even a \$100B catastrophe may not turn the softening market. **Why it matters:** buyer leverage should persist into the next renewal cycle.

NUCLEAR VERDICTS & LITIGATION FUNDING 6

C.H. Robinson hit with \$604 million nuclear verdict

Truck News · late Jul

Dallas County jury, fatal multi-vehicle crash — among the largest freight-transport verdicts ever. **Why it matters:** severity marker for any fleet/auto and umbrella program.

The largest nuclear verdicts of Q2 2026: social inflation continues

Enlyte · Q2 roundup

Enlyte's roundup of the quarter's largest verdicts; for scale, 2025 closed at 149 nuclear verdicts / \$25.1B (Litigation Sentinel). **Why it matters:** the severity trendline your casualty pricing rides on.

Insurers hail first-in-the-nation ban against litigation funding

Insurance Business America

North Carolina's Prohibit Litigation Investments Act restricts outcome-tied third-party investment. **Why it matters:** the first state ban of its kind — a template others may copy.

State roundup: NJ Assembly passes funding-transparency bill; NH bill targets foreign funders

PIA Northeast blog · Jul 2026

NJ's A-2159 (Assembly-passed, not yet law) would build a disclosure framework; NH's introduced HB1384 would bar funding from foreign adversaries. **Why it matters:** disclosure momentum is building state by state.

2026 marks a "turning point" in the war against litigation financing

Insurance Business America · 2026 · still relevant

CSAA's legal chief sees the tide turning as states move on bans and transparency. **Why it matters:** the legal environment driving casualty severity may finally be shifting.

Groups push for federal court rule to disclose litigation funding

Insurance Journal · Mar 24 · older but critical

A coalition wants federal courts to require disclosure of funders' identity and stake. **Why it matters:** federal disclosure would expose the money behind big-ticket suits nationwide.

PARAMETRIC & ALTERNATIVE RISK 2

Munich Re Specialty launches parametric earthquake insurance for corporates in Japan

Artemis · Jul 28

Seismic-trigger cover, faster payouts. **Why it matters:** parametric is mainstreaming — worth asking brokers whether similar triggers could backstop business interruption.

Two for one: when physics and finance intersect

Insurance Journal · Jul 27

The parametric/indemnity line is fading as specialty (non-admitted) carriers blend both. **Why it matters:** one-stop structures worth raising with your broker.

MANUFACTURING & WORKPLACE 7

Manufacturing was the most cyberattacked industry for the 5th straight year

ACO Insurance 2026 Market Outlook, citing IBM X-Force

27.7% of all incidents in 2025 hit manufacturers. **Why it matters:** the argument for your cyber tower size, written by the attackers.

NHTSA probes 1.2 million Tesla vehicles over suspension failure risks

Insurance Journal · Jul 31

A preliminary investigation into suspension safety concerns. **Why it matters:** a live case study in product-liability and recall exposure at manufacturing scale.

Cyber firm Wiz says flaw could have exposed thousands of Microsoft cloud customers

Insurance Journal · Jul 31

A single cloud vulnerability with mass blast radius. **Why it matters:** systemic cyber accumulation — the scenario your cyber policy's dependent-business-interruption wording exists for.

Ransomware's new AI tactic could inflate cyber claims

Insurance Business America · Jul 31

Attackers use AI pressure tactics to push victims into costly decisions. **Why it matters:** a tactic aimed at inflating claim severity, not just frequency.

Uncovered medical services are driving up workers' comp costs, WCRI finds

Risk & Insurance · Jul 31

DME and services without fee schedules are eating a growing share of comp payments. **Why it matters:** a cost driver to raise with your TPA.

How the war in Iran impacts legal contracts

Risk Management Magazine · Jul 22 · still relevant

Armed conflict doesn't automatically excuse performance. **Why it matters:** a prompt to re-read force majeure language in supplier agreements.

Defining the discoverability and privilege of AI-generated materials

Risk Management Magazine · Jul 14 · still relevant

Courts are clarifying when AI-generated materials are discoverable. **Why it matters:** governance flag as AI tools spread through the business.

LONDON MARKET & GLOBAL 3

European wildfires threaten broader economic losses

CIR / Guy Carpenter · Jul 31

Insured property losses stay modest, but wider economic impacts are expanding. **Why it matters:** supply-chain and contingent-BI exposure beyond the insured headline.

Lloyd's finds former CEO breached compliance rules

Lloyds.com · Jul 22 · still relevant

Council found an undisclosed relationship created a perceived conflict of interest. **Why it matters:** governance news at the market behind many specialty placements.

Lloyd's full-year 2025 results: £10.6bn profit before tax

Lloyds.com · FY 2025 · older but critical

The market produced strong results with £10.6bn profit before tax. **Why it matters:** strong results typically support capacity and competitive pricing — context for renewals.

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HOT TOPICS — TAP TO SPOTLIGHT

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Litigation funding 4

Parametric 2

Cyber 4

Property & cat 4

Manufacturing 6

PAYWALL & ACCESS WATCH

FLAGGED, NOT SKIPPED

Business Insurance

Returned HTTP 403 to our reader today (bot-block or subscription gate). On the team's source list for executive & emerging-risk coverage — subscription decision pending

The Insurer

Returned HTTP 401 (sign-in required). On the team's source list for reinsurance performance & executive moves — subscription decision pending

Law.com — "Defusing America's Nuclear Verdicts Crisis"

Subscription required · say the word to price it

SOURCE ROSTER — TODAY'S CHECK

✓ Risk & Insurance · ✓ Risk Management (RIMS) · ✓ Insurance Business America · ✓ Insurance Journal · ✓ Beinsure · ✓ CIR
· ✓ Artemis · ✓ Lloyd's News

✓ Modern Insurance (Issue 78 — nothing linkable retrieved today)

— Enterprise Risk (IRM quarterly — no usable new item retrieved)

🔒 Business Insurance (blocked) · 🔒 The Insurer (subscriber wall)

Sweeps: nuclear verdicts · litigation funding · parametric · manufacturing risk

Built for executive decision-making — carries straight into a CFO briefing. Auto-generated each morning by 9:00 AM CT; reply with tune-ups — sources, keywords, story count, timing.